confusing to say the least—we know that he continued to hold the position of assistant secretary until early 1908—it was probably plain misreporting on the part of the CID. These confusing details indicate that there was much scheming and undercutting by the company management.

In the light of the above, K.R. Guruswami Aiyar proudly boasted that '[SSNCo] went into the hands of the most respectable people Tuticorin and Tinnevelly could give for the purpose'.[31] But VOC had not given up. He fought a rear-guard battle and continued to work hard for the success of the company prioritizing the mobilization of the people.

Meanwhile, a political storm was brewing that would not only wreck the Swadeshi company but also upend the life of its helmsman.